



*L.N. Gumilyov Eurasian National University
Faculty of Information Technology
Department of Information Systems*

VIOLA-JONES **ALGORITHM**

Presented by: Mustafa Zhansaya



Paul Viola and Michael Jones are two computer vision researchers who introduced a revolutionary algorithm for face detection in 2001.

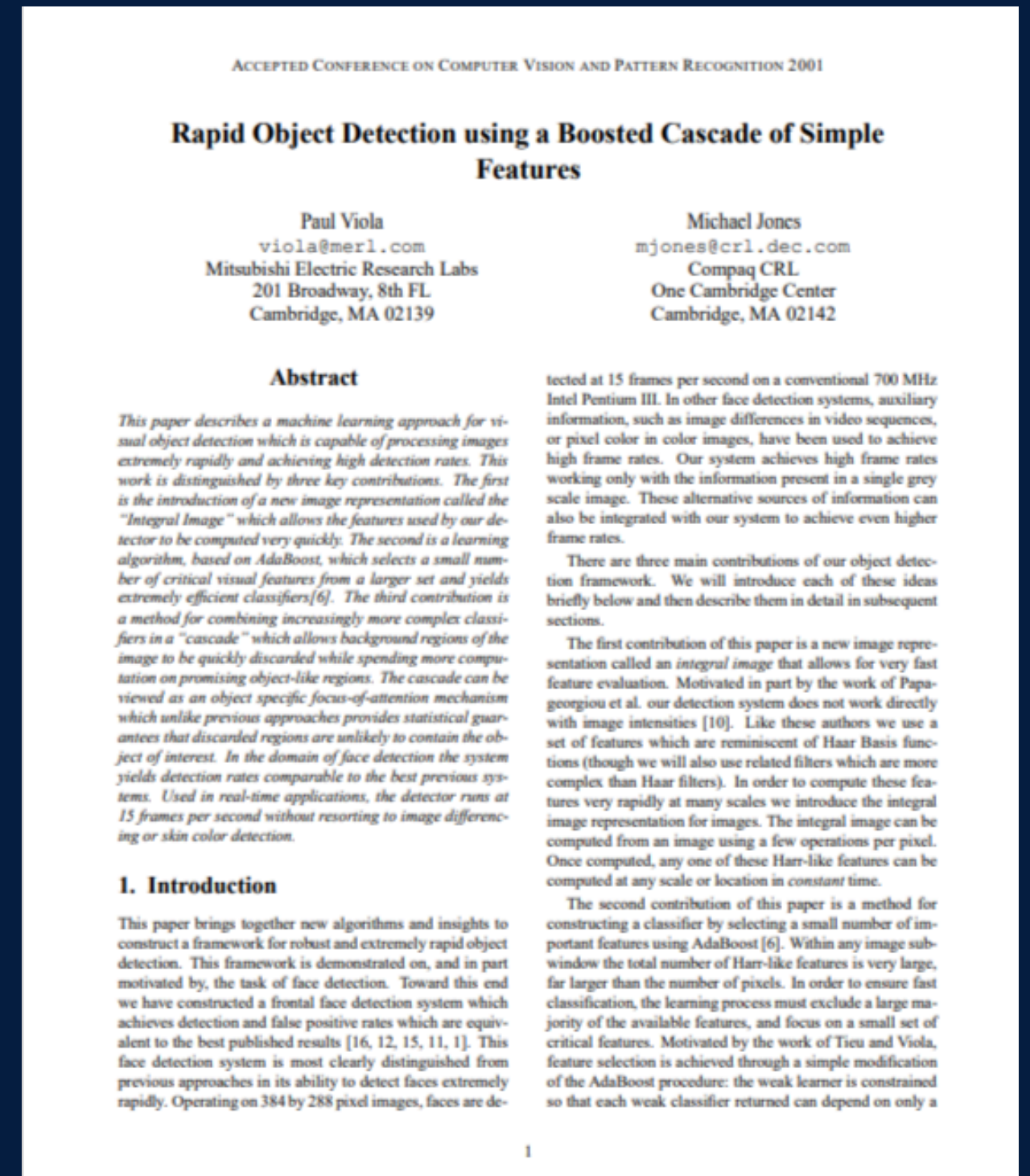
Their work was published in the article "Rapid Object Detection using a Boosted Cascade of Simple Features".



Michael J. Jones

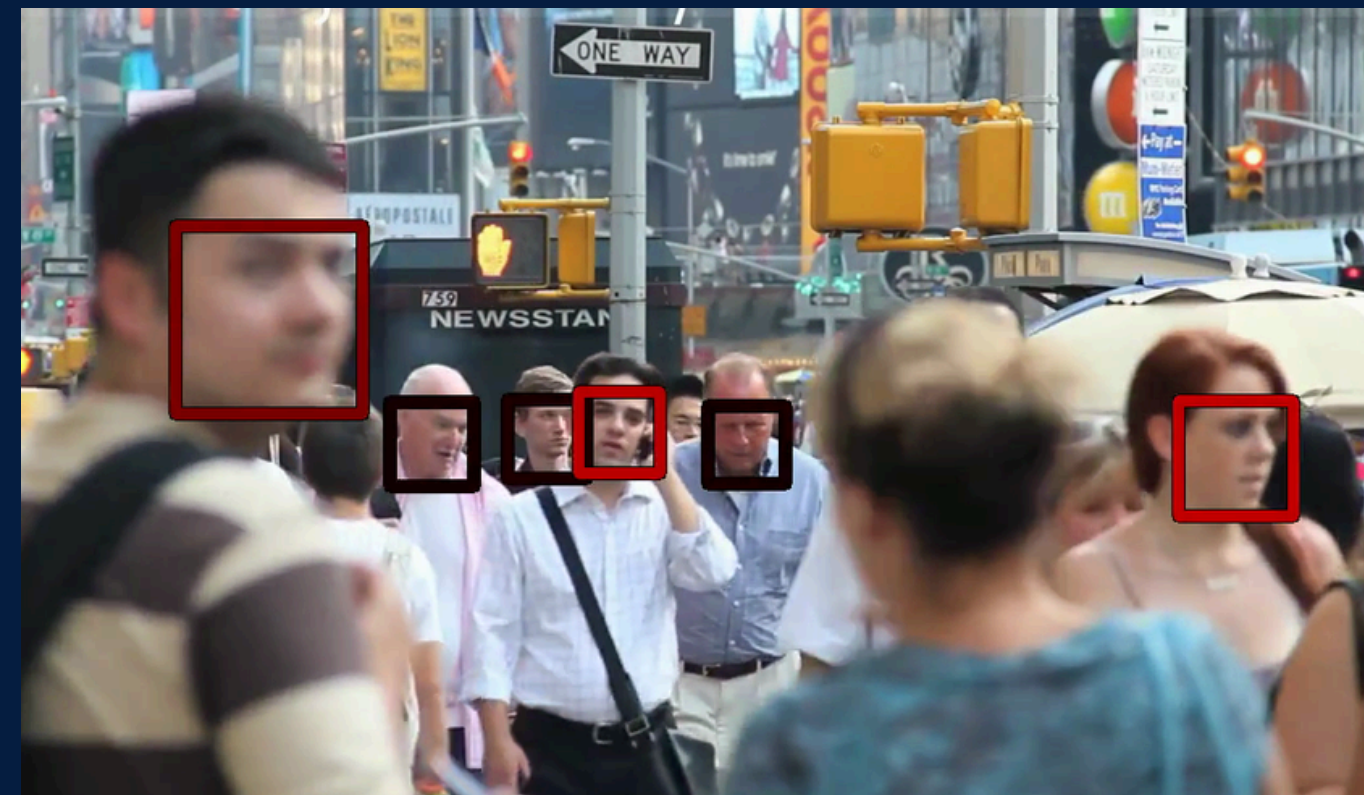


Paul A. Viola



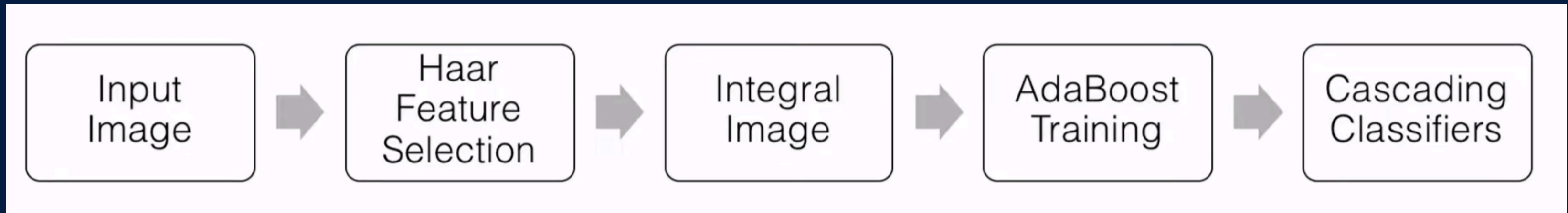
Developed in the early 2000s by Paul Viola and Michael Jones, this algorithm has become the basis for a variety of applications, from video surveillance systems to mobile devices and social networks. It is characterized by its high speed and accuracy, which makes it ideal for real-time operation.

It was successfully used in video surveillance systems for the first time. Security cameras at airports and other high-security locations have started using this algorithm to automatically detect faces, which has significantly improved the efficiency and accuracy of monitoring.



Main Steps of the Algorithm

The Viola-Jones algorithm is one of the most effective methods for detecting objects in images, especially faces. It consists of several key steps, each of which plays an important role in the recognition process.



Goal: Face detection not face recognition.

Advantages:

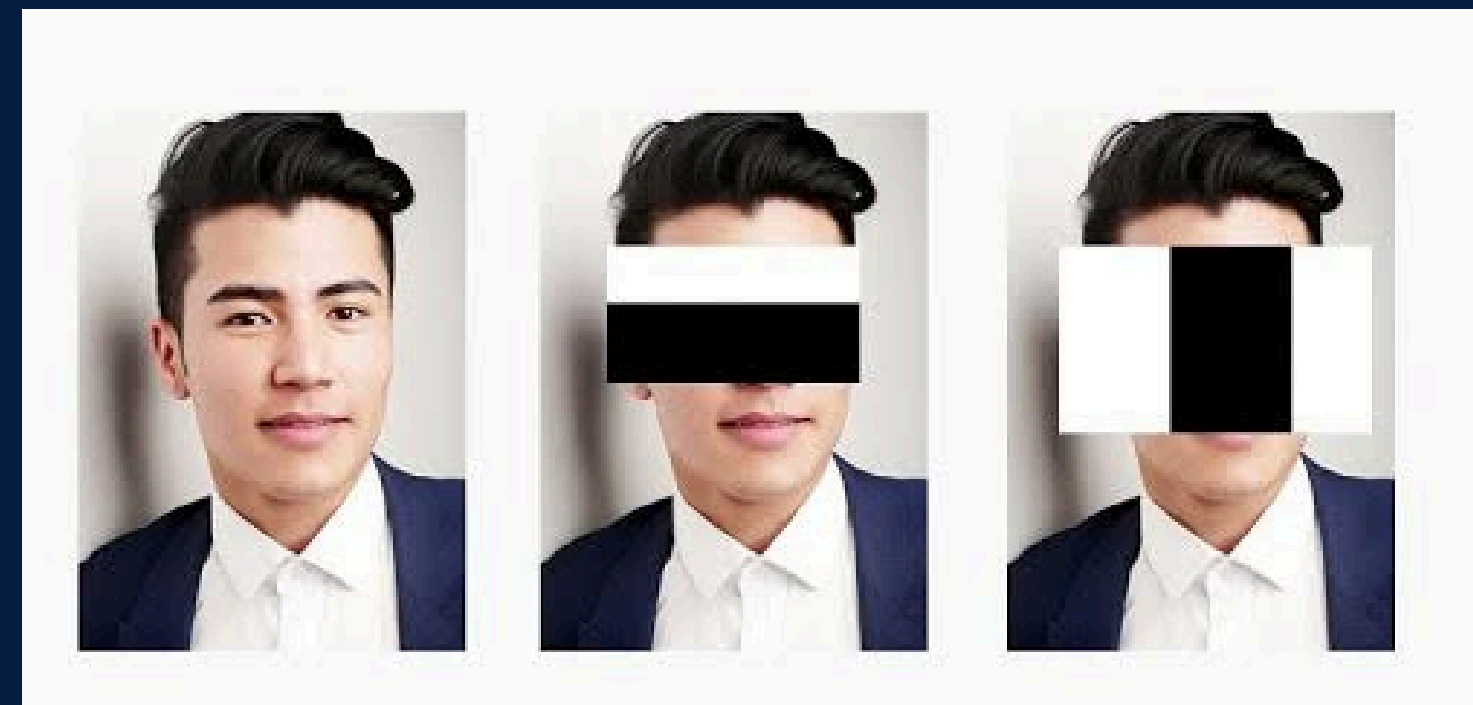
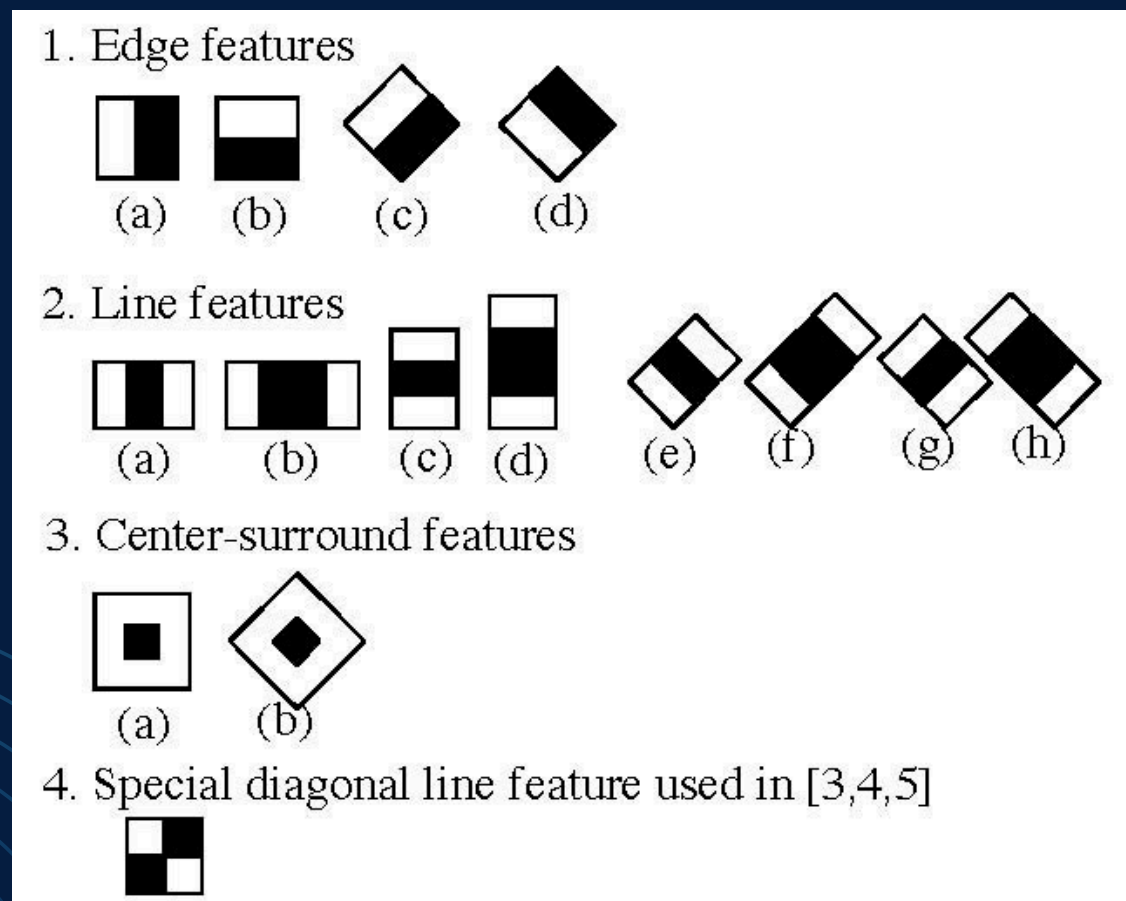
- Fast: Real-time processing.
- Robust: High correct detection rate.

Haar-like features

Haar-like features are a method used in image processing, particularly for object detection. They are based on identifying patterns of intensity differences in an image and are inspired by Haar wavelets.

Main Characteristics:

- Rectangular Regions: These features are extracted by comparing the intensity of adjacent rectangular areas.
- Edge and Texture Detection: By analyzing brightness differences, they help recognize edges, corners, and textures.
- Efficient Computation: The use of integral images allows for quick calculations, making them suitable for real-time applications.
- Feature Selection with AdaBoost: Since not all Haar-like features are equally important, an AdaBoost algorithm helps select the most relevant ones for detection.



Integral image

The integral representation of an image allows for fast computation of pixel sums in various regions of the image. This is achieved by precomputing the sums for all possible rectangular areas.

The integral image is constructed as follows:

- For each pixel (x,y) , the integral value $I(x,y)$ is calculated as the sum of all pixels in the rectangle formed by the top-left corner $(0,0)$ and the current pixel (x,y) .
- This enables the computation of pixel sums within any rectangular region in constant time, regardless of its size.

Advantages of Using Integral Image

- Constant-time computation of rectangular sums.
- Efficient scaling of Haar-like features for multi-scale detection.
- Enables real-time object detection, such as face recognition.

	0	0	0	0	0
1	0	1	3	5	9
3	0	4	10	13	22
2	0	6	15	21	32
4	0	10	20	31	46
6	0	16	29	42	58

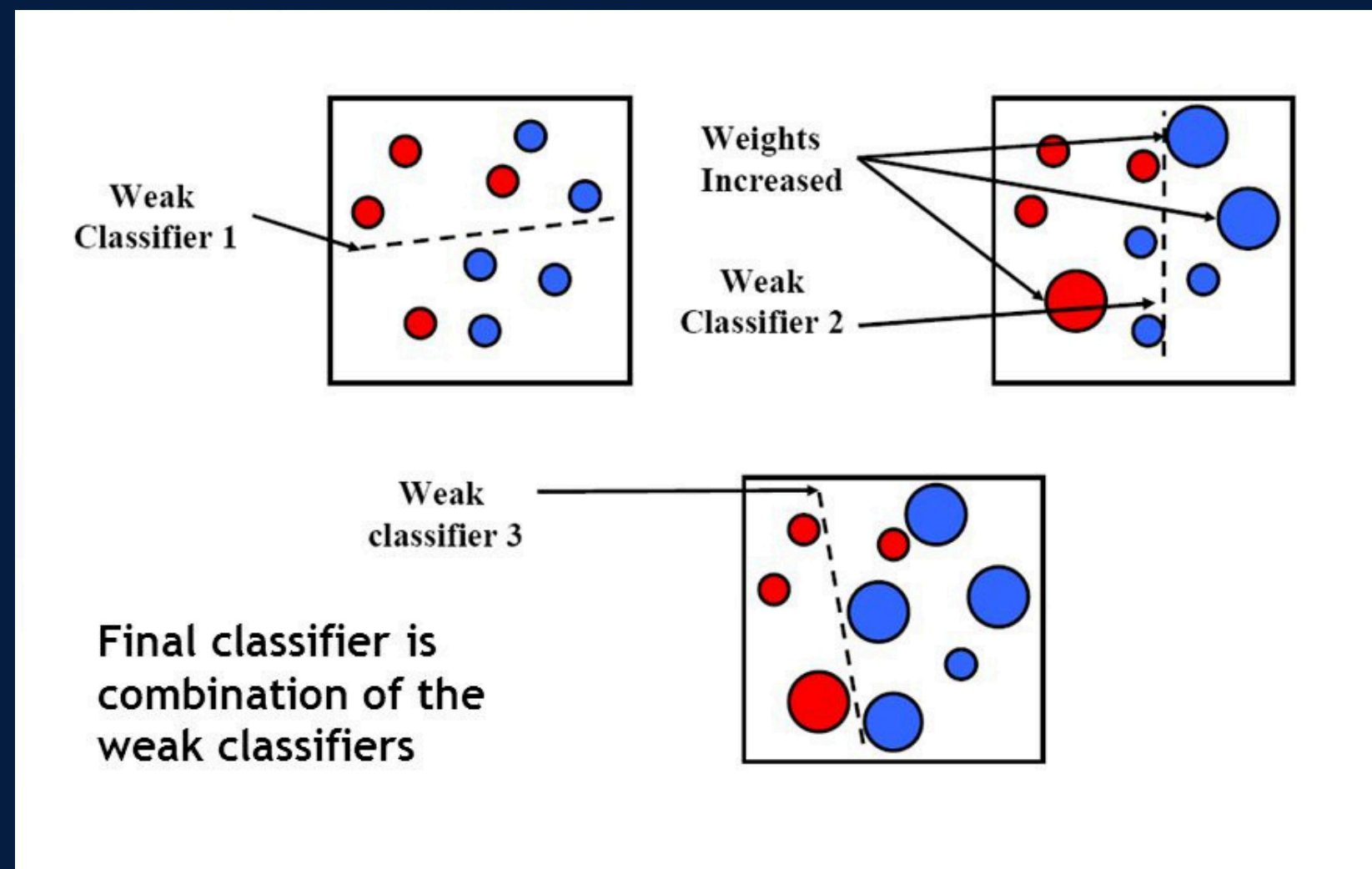
input image integral image

AdaBoost training

AdaBoost (Adaptive Boosting) is used for selecting the most informative features and training a classifier. This algorithm combines multiple "weak" classifiers into a single "strong" classifier. Weak classifiers typically have low accuracy, but their combination allows achieving high accuracy.

Main steps of AdaBoost:

- Initializing weights for each instance in the training set.
- Sequential training of weak classifiers, where each classifier focuses on minimizing errors made in previous steps.
- Combining weak classifiers using a weighted sum, where the weights are determined by the accuracy of each classifier.

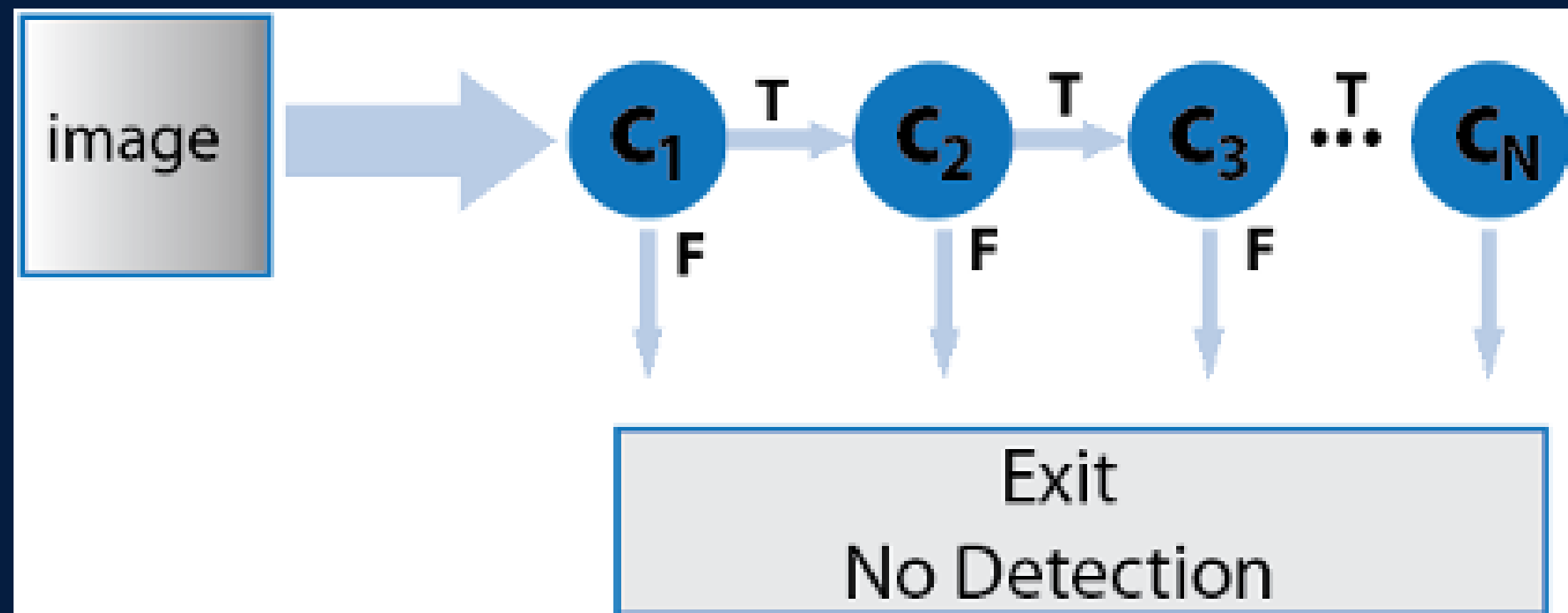


Cascade of Classifiers

A cascade classifier consists of multiple stages, each containing several weak AdaBoost classifiers. This approach allows for the rapid elimination of image regions that do not contain the object of interest (e.g., a face), significantly improving detection efficiency.

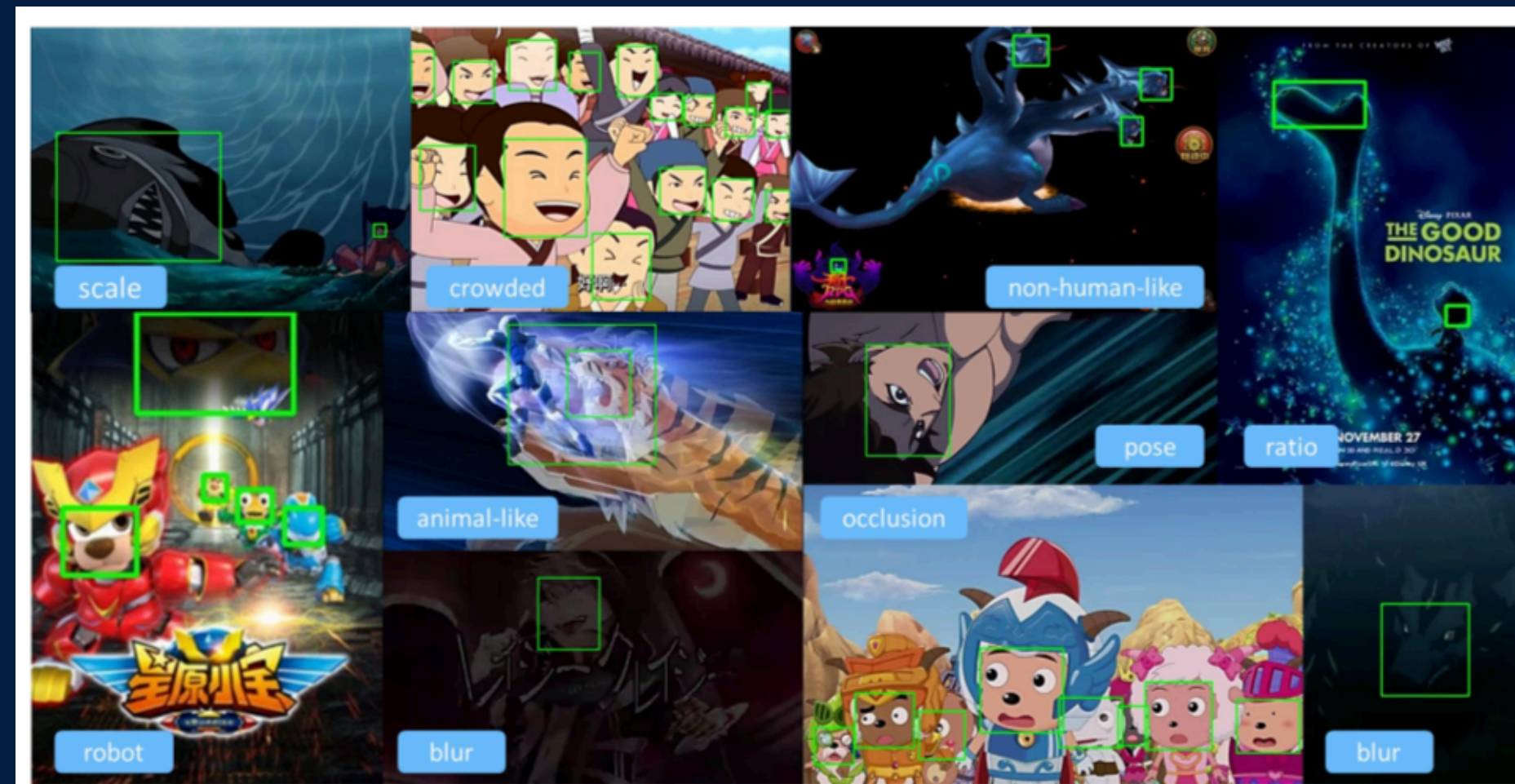
Key principles of a cascade classifier:

- Progressive filtering: Each stage of the cascade uses a small set of weak classifiers to quickly discard non-relevant regions.
- Sequential refinement: Only the regions that pass all stages of the cascade are classified as containing the object of interest.
- Optimized thresholds: The decision thresholds at each stage are set to balance false positives and processing speed, ensuring high efficiency while minimizing misclassifications.



Conclusion

Despite the rise of deep learning-based approaches, the Viola-Jones algorithm has maintained its relevance. Apple utilized an enhanced version of this algorithm for face detection in their devices until around 2014–2015. Even today, platforms like Snapchat continue to use it for facial feature detection in filters and augmented reality applications. While modern deep learning models offer greater precision, the Viola-Jones algorithm remains a practical choice for resource-efficient and real-time detection tasks, cementing its legacy in computer vision.





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**Thank's for
your
attention!**

Connect with me



zhansaya280404@gmail.com